

Mental Health Support App

1. Product Overview

Vision:

For counsellors and students who need to access and provide mental health support. The CampusCompass is an app that allows students access support through messaging, activity bookings, FAQs, and questionnaires while allowing counsellors to efficiently manage appointments and prioritise student needs.

Problem Statement:

University students frequently experience stress, anxiety, and isolation. However, existing support systems present several barriers:

- Long wait times for appointments
- Complex or manual booking systems
- Stigma around seeking help
- Lack of immediate or low-pressure communication options

As a result, many students delay or avoid seeking support until their situation worsens.

Value Proposition:

The Campus Compass app provides:

- A feature that allows users to start a chat thread instead of face-to-face communication
- A feature that ranks the urgency of a situation for a counsellor through a questionnaire
- A feature where users can book and manage activities
- A feature where users can search an FAQ page

This reduces friction, enables early intervention, and improves the efficiency of counselling services

2. Personas and User Stories

Student Persona A: Rory - First Year Undergraduate

- Feels stressed and overwhelmed by coursework
- Hesitant to seek help due to shyness
- Needs private, low-pressure support

Student Persona B: Jack - Second Year Undergraduate

- Overwhelmed and needs immediate help
- Prefers fast, direct, face-to-face support
- Values efficiency and speed

Student Persona C: Mei - International MSc Student

- Struggles with language and cultural adjustment
- Prefers written communication
- Needs reassurance and time to process responses

Counsellor Persona A: Sarah - Wellbeing Officer

- Manages large volumes of students
- Needs clear status tracking and scheduling tools
- Overwhelmed by manual processes

Counsellor Persona B: Oliver - External Counsellor

- Works part-time with limited availability
- Focuses on early intervention and accessibility
- Needs tools to reduce repetitive queries

3. MVP Scope

Core Features:

1. Support Thread (Messaging System)

Enables students to communicate with counsellors in a low-pressure format

Student Features:

- Start a new support request
- View conversations
- Send follow-up messages

Counsellor Features:

- View all student requests
- Open conversation threads
- Reply to students
- View status (Waiting / Replied)

2. Questionnaire (Urgency System)

Assesses risk level and allows prioritisation of cases

Student Features:

- Complete questionnaire before starting a chat
- Emergency services pop-up for high-risk responses
- Priority level hidden from student

Counsellor Features:

- View urgency-based priority list
- Use priority to triage responses

3. Booking System

Allows students to schedule sessions and counsellors to manage availability

Student Features:

- Book:
 - In-person sessions
 - Online meetings
 - Well-being activities
- View and cancel their bookings

Counsellor Features:

- View calendar of bookings
- Cancel sessions
- Set availability (including limited working days)
- View and edit sessions

4. FAQ System

Provides quick answers and reduces repetitive queries

Student Features:

- Search FAQs by topic
- Start a support thread if no answer is found

Counsellor Features:

- Create and manage FAQ content

User Stories & Prioritisation

Must Have:

- Support thread
- Booking system
- Urgency questionnaire
- Counsellor dashboard

These features were prioritised as they directly support accessibility, triage, and intervention, which are all critical in mental health crises.

Should Have:

- FAQ system
- FAQ → support thread shortcut

These features improve efficiency but are not essential for initial access to support

Roles & Permissions

Students:

- Access own data only
- Cannot view priority level
- Cannot modify system content

Counsellors:

- Access assigned student requests
- Manage bookings, FAQs, and activities
- View urgency levels

User Flows:

Student:

1. Login
2. Complete Questionnaire
3. Select topic and start support thread
4. Send and receive messages
5. Book appointment or activity
6. Manage bookings

Counsellor:

1. Login
2. View dashboard of chat status and priority
3. Respond to chats
4. View and manage appointments
5. Update activities and FAQ

Functional Requirements:

Students:

- Register and log in
- Submit support requests
- Complete questionnaire before chat
- Send and receive messages
- Search FAQs
- Book and manage appointments

Counsellors:

- View and filter chats by status and urgency
- Respond to student messages
- Manage availability and bookings
- Create FAQ content
- Manage activities

Non-Functional Requirements:

- Security & Privacy - must comply with data protection regulations e.g GDPR
- Performance - messaging should function with minimal delay.
- Availability- system should be accessible at all times.
- Usability- interface should be simple and reduce stress for users.

Success Metrics

- Number of support threads created
- Questionnaire completion rate
- Average response time
- Booking conversion rate
- FAQ usage vs support thread creation

- User retention rate

4. Risks and Mitigations

Risks:

- Delayed responses could negatively impact users
- Crisis situations may not be fully supported

Mitigation:

- Emergency services pop-up for high-risk users
- Clear communication that the app is not for emergency use

5. Sprint Breakdown

Sprint 1:

- Login
- Messaging system (support threads)

Outcome:

A working communication system which allows students to seek help and receive responses and allows counsellors to provide help while being able to view which messages they have or haven't replied to.

Sprint 2:

- Questionnaire (urgency system)
- Booking system
- FAQ
- Activities management

Outcome:

A complete system capable of determining risk, managing student demands, and supporting urgent cases.

6. Conclusion

The CampusCompass MVP prioritises accessibility and early intervention by first enabling low-pressure communication through a support chat thread. By additionally adding urgency detection, FAQs, and a booking system counsellors are able to focus on mitigating emergencies and managing crises through workshops or one-on-one meetings. Students are also able to receive the help they need this way.